THE OHIO STATE UNIVERSITY
COLLEGE OF SOCIAL WORK

PhD Program
Guidelines on the Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in Candidacy & Dissertation

Candidacy Examination

This policy provides guidelines for ethical and responsible use of AI-assisted technologies and tools in candidacy examination. PhD students are permitted to use AI-assisted technologies and tools that align with expectations of candidacy examination. These expectations are:

- Candidacy examination submissions are expected to be students' **original scholarship and writing.**
- Students' ability to demonstrate **mastery of skills independent of AI-assisted technologies and tools.**
- Authenticity of human work with the **student as the driver** of the scholarship.

Students should consult with their advisors and committee members on the intended use if planning on using AI-assisted technologies and tools in preparing their candidacy submissions.

Students should refer to Ohio State University approved AI-assisted technologies and tools (https://ai.osu.edu/resources-buckeyes/approved-ai-tools), AI research guidelines, and https://www.journals.uchicago.edu/doi/10.1086/739116 for ethical and responsible use of AI. In addition, it is the student's responsibility to verify all AI generated information for accuracy.

A **disclosure statement regarding the use of AI is required if you have used AI in your candidacy work.** This disclosure must be described in detail and in accordance with the University's guidelines and policies on academic integrity. An example of a disclosure statement:

I am the sole author of this candidacy paper. Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools were used exclusively for language proofreading (e.g., breaking down long sentences) and for supporting both academic and non-academic literature searches. All suggested language changes and identified literature were reviewed and verified by me to ensure accuracy. The structural organization, original (non-referenced) content, argumentation, proposed methods, and conclusions presented in this candidacy submission are entirely my own work.

Examples of appropriate use of AI-assisted technologies and tools include the following:

- Writing assistance: Improve spelling, grammar, and the structure of writing.
- Supporting academic and non-academic literature searches, with references verified by the student for accuracy.

Examples of inappropriate use of AI-assisted technologies and tools include the following:

- Copy and paste directly from AI generated documents into candidacy documents.
- While it could be helpful to further refine ideas, the use of AI-assisted technologies and tools to brainstorm ideas and draft research questions that do not originate from the students is inappropriate for candidacy.

- Use AI-assisted technologies and tools to synthesize information and draw conclusions.
- Use generative AI-assisted technologies and tools to generate content of candidacy documents.
- Upload candidacy questions to AI-assisted technologies and tools to receive guidance and feedback during the examination period.

The College of Social Work PhD Program will not accept candidacy examination submissions that are either substantially developed by artificial intelligence (AI), or contain sections substantially developed by AI. If unethical use of AI is identified in candidacy submissions, the College may refer the matter to the Committee on Academic Misconduct (COAM) to determine whether there is research misconduct while pausing candidacy until further notice.

Please contact the PhD Program Office if your study focus is on AI-assisted technologies and tools, or a topic that will require exceptions to this guideline.

Dissertation

The College of Social Work PhD Program promotes **ethical, responsible, and open science in doctoral dissertation research**. This policy provides guidelines for ethical and responsible use of AI-assisted technologies and tools in the dissertation process. PhD students are permitted to use AI-assisted technologies and tools that align with expectations of dissertation work. These expectations are:

- Dissertation work is expected to be students' **original scholarship and writing**
- Students' ability to demonstrate **mastery of skills independent of AI-assisted technologies and tools**
- Authenticity of human work with the **student as the driver** of the research.

Students should consult with their advisors and committee members on the intended use if planning on using AI-assisted technologies and tools in preparing their dissertation work.

Students should refer to Ohio State University approved AI-assisted technologies and tools (https://ai.osu.edu/resources-buckeyes/approved-ai-tools), AI research guidelines, and https://www.journals.uchicago.edu/doi/10.1086/739116 for ethical and responsible use of AI-assisted technologies and tools. In addition, it is the student's responsibility to verify all AI generated information for accuracy.

A disclosure statement regarding the use of AI is required if you have used AI in your dissertation work. This disclosure must be described in detail and in accordance with the University's guidelines and policies on academic integrity. An example of a disclosure statement:

I am the sole author of this dissertation, including all three sub-studies. Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools were used exclusively for language proofreading (e.g., breaking down long sentences) and for supporting both academic and non-academic literature searches. All suggested language changes and identified literature were reviewed and verified by me to ensure accuracy. The structural organization, original (non-referenced) content, analysis, argumentation, and conclusions presented in this dissertation are entirely my own work.

Examples of appropriate use of AI-assisted technologies and tools include the following:

- Writing assistance: Improve spelling, grammar, and the structure of writing.
- Data preparation: e.g., use AI-assisted technologies and tools to help with transcription, which should be reviewed and compared to the audio recording by the student.
- Data analysis: Use AI tools to help with data analysis when appropriate and in consultation with the advisor and committee members.

Examples of inappropriate use of AI-assisted technologies and tools include the following:

- Copy and paste directly from AI generated documents into the dissertation.
- While it could be helpful to further refine ideas, the use of AI-assisted technologies and tools to brainstorm ideas and draft research questions that do not originate from the students is inappropriate for dissertation.
- Use AI-assisted technologies and tools to summarize and synthesize findings of the dissertation study.
- Use AI-assisted technologies and tools to draw conclusions.

- Use generative AI-assisted technologies and tools to generate content of the dissertation.

To maintain the integrity of the dissertation, the College of Social Work PhD Program will not accept dissertation submissions that are either substantially developed by artificial intelligence (AI), or contain sections substantially developed by AI. If unethical use of AI is identified in a dissertation, the College may refer the matter to the Committee on Academic Misconduct (COAM) to determine whether there is research misconduct while simultaneously taking actions including the halting of the matriculation of the student towards graduation until further notice. In addition, per OSU AI research guidelines, if AI misuse includes a credible allegation of plagiarism or an allegation of fabrication and/or falsification of research data using generative artificial intelligence, the matter will be reviewed under the University Policy on Research Misconduct by the Office of Research Compliance.

Please contact the PhD Program Office if your study focus is on AI-assisted technologies and tools, or on a topic that will require exceptions to this guideline.